

Homewise VOC Synthesis: 4 Interviews

SAMPLE QUALITY NOTE

Before the findings: only one participant matches your primary user. The renter (Interview 2) is explicitly out of scope. Interviews 3 and 4 are experienced homeowners who found contractors through social proof. Interview 1 is your closest match to the burned-out homeowner archetype. You have zero interviews with a true new homeowner navigating contractor hiring cold — your stated MVP target. Treat this research as directional, not representative.

FINDING 1: Trust is social before it is digital

Three of four participants found contractors through personal or social proof first: a neighbor recommendation, watching a contractor work in the neighborhood, referrals from friends. Only Interview 1 went deep into Yelp and Angi, and he still layered it with referrals. Interview 2 used Yelp out of urgency, not preference, and ended up dissatisfied.

The implication: your primary user is not choosing between digital platforms. They are choosing between "I have no network" and desperation. That is the exact void Homewise needs to fill. But the product needs to feel like a trusted referral, not a rating aggregator.

FINDING 2: Scope uncertainty is the actual problem. Price is a symptom.

Every participant who felt uncertain about price was actually uncertain about scope. The renter did not know if \$380 was fair because she had no reference for what the job entailed. Interview 1 got quotes ranging from \$250 to \$7,000 for the same rotting siding because contractors proposed fundamentally different interventions. He could not compare prices because he could not compare scopes.

His proposed solution: hire an expert to diagnose only, generate a defined scope, then solicit comparable quotes. He understood exactly why it is hard to implement — professionals do not want to be paid for diagnosis only, contractors resist externally defined scope. That is a real market structure problem, not a UX problem.

Interviews 3 and 4 had smaller scope failures: wrong materials, color mismatches, unexpected costs from material substitution. These are execution-layer scope failures, not discovery-layer.

For Homewise: the AI's job is not just "find a trustworthy contractor." It is "define what job actually needs to be done, so quotes are comparable." That is a harder product problem than may currently be scoped.

FINDING 3: Verification behavior splits by experience level

Interview 2: Yelp ratings only, no verification.

Interview 3: Asked contractors directly for license and insurance.

Interview 4: Saw a license number on a business card. No further check.

Interview 1: Actively looked up license, insurance, and bond through websites, using AI to find which sites to use.

Experienced homeowners do not do rigorous verification unless they have been burned. New and inexperienced users do not know what to verify. Nobody spontaneously checked permit history or anything comparable to Shovels data.

This validates progressive disclosure, but tells you something sharper: the depth layer exists for users who already know they want it. The surface layer needs to make verification feel like it happened even if the user did not do it themselves. "Verified by Homewise" has to carry weight that a Yelp star rating does not.

FINDING 4: Quote comparison is broken by design, and users know it

Interview 1 explicitly reached for AI to compare quotes and found the output not actionable.

Without a standardized scope, you are comparing incomparable things. He identified the market analog himself: a friend's product that works only for highly standardized tasks (gutter cleaning, fence painting) because scope is measurable there.

This is a significant signal. The viable near-term version of Homewise may need to start with task categories where scope is definable. Sliding into complex, diagnostic scenarios requires a scope-definition capability the product probably does not have yet.

FINDING 5: Materials and execution control is an underexplored pain point

Interviews 3 and 4 both raised materials as a frustration. Interview 3 had budget overruns from untracked reimbursements. Interview 4 got wrong-color materials. Both wanted more control over purchasing decisions.

The "one-decision experience" pitch implies the job is done once you hire. These users show the job continues through execution. If Homewise closes the hiring loop but leaves the execution loop open, satisfaction signals will be mixed.